

Department of Information and Communication Technology

Faculty of Technology

University of Sri Jayewardenepura

Module: Information Systems Strategy and T Governance

Case Study: Strategic Planning for TechNova Solutions (Pvt) Ltd.

Background

TechNova Solutions (Pvt) Ltd. is a fast-growing IT company in Colombo, Sri Lanka. Founded in 2018 by three university friends, the company initially offered small-scale web and mobile app development services for local clients. Within a few years, demand for its services grew rapidly due to the founders' strong technical skills and word-of-mouth marketing.

By 2024, TechNova had over 100 employees and a portfolio that included clients from the education, logistics, and retail sectors. Encouraged by this success, the management decided to expand operations to India and Australia. However, the company's internal processes remained largely informal decisions were made ad hoc, budgeting was reactive, and there was no clear direction or written plan.

As the company prepared for expansion, several problems became visible:

- Project delays and client complaints had increased.
- There was no clear vision or mission statement guiding decisions.
- Departments (HR, Finance, Marketing, and IT) worked in isolation, often duplicating tasks.
- Employee turnover rose due to unclear career paths and workload imbalance.
- The founders disagreed on investment priorities some preferred expanding abroad, others wanted to focus on product innovation.

An external consultant advised TechNova to develop a formal strategic plan before proceeding with expansion.

Student Task

As a strategic planning consultant, you have been invited to guide TechNova's leadership team. Answer the following questions to analyze the company's situation and recommend a suitable strategic planning approach.

A – Understanding the Basics (Conceptual)

1. What is strategic planning and why is it essential for an organization like TechNova Solutions at its current stage of growth?
2. Explain the difference between operational planning and strategic planning. Provide one example of each from TechNova's situation.
3. Identify the main reasons why TechNova now needs a formal strategic plan.

B – Key Components of Strategic Planning

4. List and briefly explain the main components or stages of a strategic planning process.
5. Draft a possible Vision and Mission statement for TechNova Solutions that reflect its current situation and future aspirations.
6. Conduct a brief SWOT analysis for TechNova based on the case information.
7. Identify three strategic objectives that should guide TechNova's next 3–5 years of growth.

C – Analytical and Applied Thinking

8. What internal factors and external factors should TechNova analyze before finalizing its strategic plan?
9. Suggest two possible strategies TechNova can adopt to manage its expansion into India and Australia.
10. Recommend a governance or monitoring mechanism to ensure that TechNova's strategic plan is effectively implemented and reviewed.

D – Reflection

11. In your opinion, what could be the consequences if TechNova continues without a strategic plan?
12. Explain how the strategic planning process can help align employees, departments, and leadership toward common goals.

E - Strategy Development Activity

13. Develop a mini strategic plan outline for TechNova (1-page summary)
 - Include: Vision, Mission, 3 Strategic Goals, and Key Actions